

AGRI VALUE-CHAIN

FosholHub

Farmer marketplace

Bangladesh smallholders lose to middlemen and post-harvest waste; aggregation lifts income



THE SITUATION IN BANGLADESH

In Bangladesh, marginal and smallholder farmers make up roughly 83% of the farming community and work about half the cultivable land, yet most hold under 1.5 acres, leaving the sector deeply fragmented ⁶. Agriculture employs about 35–37% of the labor force but contributes only 11–12% of GDP, a gap that reflects how little value reaches the farm gate ⁷. Layers of middlemen capture most of that value: in Dhaka District farmers receive under 50% of the consumer price for key vegetables (around 33% for tomato, 39% for cauliflower), while consumers pay two to three times the farm-gate price ¹³. On top of this, post-harvest losses are severe, with vegetables losing about 25% and roughly one-third of all horticultural produce wasted for lack of storage, cold chain and transport ².

OUR PITCH

FosholHub buys produce directly from smallholders, aggregates it, and sells to buyers, collapsing the intermediary chain that today drains farmer margins and inflates consumer prices ¹³. Aggregation through producer-organization models has measurable income effects: survey evidence shows membership raising marketed surplus 25%, production value 18%, and total income 15% ⁴. Better market linkage also lifts farm-gate prices directly, with internet and price-information access shown to win farmers up to 5% higher prices ⁸, while shorter chains and faster offtake cut the post-harvest spoilage that erases a quarter of vegetable value ². Digital agri precedents in the region prove the model scales cheaply, with platforms reaching millions of farmers at well under a dollar each and benefit-cost ratios of 9–15 ⁹, and Bangladeshi players like iFarmer and AgroMukam already validate demand for input-and-buyer connectivity ⁵. FosholHub's wedge is owning the aggregation and offtake layer rather than only publishing prices, turning information advantage into guaranteed purchase and a fairer split for the farmer.

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